SETUP GUIDE

AUTOMATE YOUR TAX SEASON

Invoice Intake & Logging

A ready-made n8n workflow that watches your inbox, reads every invoice, logs it to a Google Sheet, and pings you on Telegram. Import it, connect four things, and let it run.

By **Felix Sattler**

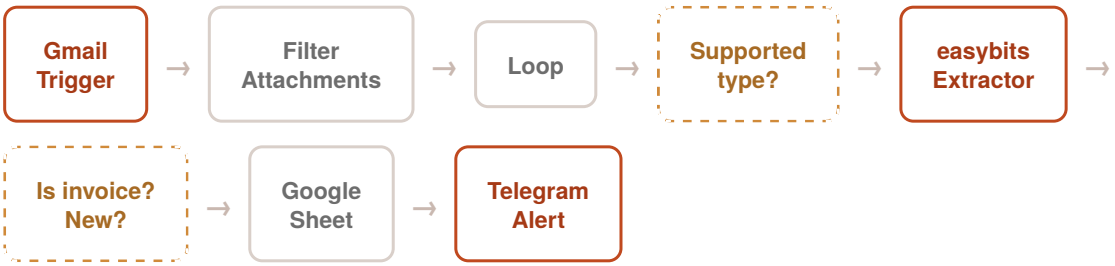
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What this workflow does

This is a **deterministic** invoice pipeline, no agent, no guesswork. It watches a Gmail inbox for unread mail, pulls the attachments, reads the invoice fields with the easybits Extractor, and writes each new invoice to a Google Sheet. Duplicate invoices are skipped automatically, and an optional Telegram alert lands on your phone the moment one is processed.

When tax season starts and your lawyer asks for everything, the sheet is already filled in. You can even forward invoices from other inboxes, and the workflow will process those too.

How the data flows



Trigger, then processing, then output, the same shape every n8n workflow follows. The dashed nodes are the IF checks that keep junk and duplicates out.

Before you start. You will need a Gmail account, a free easybits Extractor account (**extractor.easybits.tech**), a Google account for Sheets, and, if you want phone alerts, a Telegram bot. Nothing else.

Set it up in three steps

The core of the workflow is three connections. Telegram is an optional fourth, covered after.

1 Import the workflow & connect Gmail

In n8n, open the **three-dot menu** (top right) and choose **Import from File**, then select the `easybits_invoice_intake_and_logging.json` file. The whole workflow, including the notes, appears on your canvas.

Click the **Trigger: New Unread Email** node and open the **Credentials** dropdown. Add your Gmail OAuth2 credential, or pick an existing one. The important part is pointing it at the inbox you actually want invoices pulled from.

> **Already enabled for you:** attachment download and the unread filter. You do not need to touch the node's settings.

2 Build your Extractor pipeline

Head to **extractor.easybits.tech** and create a **new pipeline** (I called mine "Invoice Document Classification"). The easiest route is to upload one example invoice and click **Auto-mapping**, it reads your document and maps the fields for you. You can refine the mapping afterward under **Edit Mapping**.

Make sure your pipeline returns these fields, since the rest of the workflow relies on the exact names:

Field	What it holds
`document_class`	Must return `invoice` for real invoices, this is what filters out other documents
`invoice_number`	Used as the unique key for duplicate detection
`vendor_name`	Who issued the invoice
`service_name`	What was billed
`service_period`	The period the invoice covers
`total_net`	Net amount
`vat_amount`	VAT amount
`total_gross`	Gross total

> Then back in n8n, open the **Extract: Document Fields** node, add a new credential, and paste in your **Pipeline ID** and **API key**. Both are on your pipeline page under **View Pipeline**.

3 Connect your Google Sheet

Make your own copy of the invoice sheet (**File → Make a copy**) so the column headers already match. Grab the template here:

```
docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/15nHI4UvoUv_hAt64s2Gp56qnQ5Jz8in_3xpNOGgrUhM
```

Then open **both** Google Sheets nodes, **Sheets: Find Existing Invoice** and **Sheets: Append Invoice Row**, add your Google Sheets credential, and select your copied spreadsheet and the `Invoices` tab in each.

> **One rule that matters:** the column headers in your sheet must match the field names from step 2 exactly (`invoice_number`, `vendor_name`, and so on). That is how the rows line up.

Why two Sheets nodes? The first one looks up the invoice number to see if it already exists; the IF check after it only lets through numbers it did not find. That is the duplicate guard, so the same invoice never gets logged twice.

— Optional: Telegram alerts

Not required, I added it so I always have the overview on my phone. Skip this and the workflow still logs everything to the sheet.

4 Connect your Telegram bot

Create a bot with **BotFather** on Telegram (it walks you through it and hands you a token). In the **Telegram: Send Invoice Alert** node, add that token as a new credential, then replace the `chatId` placeholder with your own chat ID. You will get a tidy message with the vendor, service, period, invoice number, and the financials every time an invoice lands.

Go live

Test run first

Send yourself an email with an invoice attached and execute the workflow manually. Check that the row appears in your sheet and, if set up, the Telegram message arrives.

Then activate

Flip the workflow to **Active**. The Gmail trigger polls every minute, so from now on every new invoice is processed on its own.

- ✓ Gmail credential connected, pointed at the right inbox
- ✓ Extractor pipeline built and returning all eight fields
- ✓ Extractor credential (Pipeline ID + API key) added to the node
- ✓ Both Google Sheets nodes pointed at your copied sheet
- ✓ Column headers match the field names exactly
- ✓ Telegram connected and chat ID set (optional)
- ✓ Test run passed, then workflow activated

If something looks off, open the **Executions** tab and step through the last run node by node. Check what the node *before* the failing one actually passed on, most issues are a field-name mismatch or a pipeline that did not return `document_class`.

Questions as you go?

Happy to help you get it running

People reach out about these setups all the time. The easiest way is to grab a free 15-minute call.

Book a free 15-minute call

Or email me directly at **felix.sattler@easybits.tech**
calendly.com/felix-sattler-easybits/easybits-15-minute-meeting

That is the whole setup. Import, connect four things, and let tax season run itself.

Best,

Felix